

PS50008A Textbook

Research Methods & Experimental Design

Gordon Wright

1 Welcome

This textbook accompanies PS50008A Research Methods & Experimental Design at Goldsmiths, University of London. It contains all lecture and lab readings organised by week, along with self-assessment quizzes to check your understanding.

2 How to Use This Textbook

Each week has **two readings** to complete:

1. **Lecture reading** — Read before or after Wednesday's lecture to reinforce the concepts
2. **Lab reading** — Read before Thursday's lab to prepare for practical exercises

After each week, test your understanding with the self-assessment quiz. These match the style of the MCQ exam.

PDF Downloads

Each chapter and quiz can be downloaded as a PDF for offline reading. Look for the PDF link at the top of each page.

3 Weekly Readings

Week	Lecture Reading	Lab Reading	Quiz
11	Introduction to Research	DataLab Foundations	Week 11 Quiz
12	Research Design Framework	Introduction to R	Week 12 Quiz
13	Estimation & Confidence Intervals	Bootstrap CIs in R	Week 13 Quiz
14	Inference & t-tests	t-tests in R	Week 14 Quiz

Week	Lecture Reading	Lab Reading	Quiz
15	Correlation	Correlation in R	Week 15 Quiz
—	<i>Reading Week</i>	<i>Research Plan work</i>	—
16	Regression	Project Groups	Week 16 Quiz
17	Interpretation & Credibility	Project Groups	Week 17 Quiz
18	MCQ Exam Prep	Project Groups	Week 18 Quiz
19	Project Workshop	Data Collection	Week 19 Quiz
20	Wrapping Up	Report Writing	Week 20 Quiz

! Week 12 is Critical

Week 12 introduces ALL the terminology you need for your Research Plan: IV, DV, design types, hypothesis types, test selection, and descriptive statistics.

4 Assessment Deadlines

Week	Assessment
16	Research Plan due Fri 27 Feb (20%)
18	MCQ Exam Mon 9 Mar (20%)
19	EDS Assignment due Fri 20 Mar (20%)
Post-term	Research Report due Fri 1 May (40%)

5 Quick Reference

- Assessment Overview
- Resources
- Data Dictionary
- Schedule